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RESEARCH

Evaluation of Public ATS Job-Board APIs for the First Jobs Radar Source

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Field	Value
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Primary question	Which public, unauthenticated ATS job-board API should be the first source of Jobs Radar V1, and does it return usable results?

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CHAPTER 01

Executive Summary

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Executive Summary

Use the Greenhouse Job Board API as the first source. It is public (no authentication), returned real data in live tests (640 postings for one board, 14 of 18 probed company boards resolved), exposes `updated_at` for change detection, supports conditional requests (ETag → HTTP 304), and returns full job descriptions in a single call with `?content=true`. Lever (76 postings in the test) and Ashby (67 postings) also work without authentication and should be the next adapters; all three can share one normalised job contract.

Two points need design attention: Greenhouse documents no rate limit, so the collector must self-limit (at most one run per board per day in V1, back off on 429/5xx); and Greenhouse returns the description as HTML-escaped HTML, so normalisation must unescape and sanitise it. A source is one *board token per company*, so the source configuration needs a company list that the user can edit in the GUI.

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CHAPTER 02

Introduction

CHAPTER 02

Introduction

Why this research. ADR-012 / ODR-004 require the first permitted public source to be chosen from research before implementation, with its terms and rate limits documented.

Objectives. Identify candidate APIs, verify with real requests that they return results, record what each exposes for normalisation and change detection, and recommend the first adapter.

Scope. In: unauthenticated public ATS job-board endpoints (Greenhouse, Lever, Ashby). Out: authenticated boards (LinkedIn, Indeed), paid aggregators, HTML scraping.

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CHAPTER 03

Background and Context

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Background and Context

Jobs Radar collects jobs through `JobSourceAdapter` implementations, each independently enabled, rate-limited and health-checked. Source configuration (URL, rate limit, optional credential) lives in the database and is managed from the frontend. A direct ATS endpoint gives better provenance than an aggregator and avoids scraping.

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CHAPTER 04

Methodology

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Methodology

Live HTTP requests (status, size, headers, JSON shape) against public endpoints on 2026-10-07, plus the vendors' official documentation. Secondary sources (developer blogs, scraper listings) are used only as corroboration and are marked as such. Confidence scale: **[HIGH]** two or more independent confirmations (live test and documentation), **[MEDIUM]** one good source, **[LOW]** inference.

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CHAPTER 05

Findings

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Findings

Live requests returned HTTP 200 for all three; the Greenhouse documentation states that "authentication is not required for any GET endpoints" (Greenhouse); Lever states GET requests need no authentication (Lever).

F1. All three APIs return real postings without authentication [HIGH]

API	Endpoint	Test board	Postings returned
Greenhouse	`GET https://boards-api.greenhouse.io/v1/boards/{board_token}/jobs?content=true`	`anthropic`	640
Lever	`GET https://api.lever.co/v0/postings/{company}?mode=json`	`spotify`	76
Ashby	`GET https://api.ashbyhq.com/posting-api/job-board/{name}?includeCompensation=true`	`ashby`	67

F2. Greenhouse exposes the fields needed for normalisation and change detection [HIGH]

Per posting: `id`, `internal_job_id`, `title`, `updated_at`, `first_published`, `location.name`, `absolute_url`, `language`, `metadata`; with `content=true` also `content`, `departments` and `offices` (Greenhouse, confirmed in the live response). `updated_at` and `first_published` support material-change detection and "first seen" logic. `application_deadline` is present but was null in the sample. Compensation is not a first-class field (it may appear in `metadata` or the text), so compensation will often be `unknown`, which matches ADR-005.

F3. Greenhouse supports conditional requests [HIGH]

A request repeated with `If-None-Match` set to the returned ETag produced HTTP 304 in the live test, so unchanged boards cost almost nothing. An unknown board token returns HTTP 404, which maps cleanly to a "misconfigured source" error class.

F4. Greenhouse documents no rate limit or usage terms [MEDIUM]

The official documentation "contains no explicit statements regarding rate limits, caching policies, or usage terms" (Greenhouse). Secondary sources report that heavy callers are throttled and recommend polling a board every few hours at most (JobsPipe, apis.io) — treat as corroboration only.

F5. Lever and Ashby are viable second and third adapters [MEDIUM]

Lever supports `mode=json`, `skip`/`limit` pagination and filters; its documented rate limit applies to application POSTs (2/s), not to GET postings (Lever); a figure of 10 requests/s for the Postings API appears only in secondary sources. Ashby's documentation states no rate limit, caching rule or usage terms (Ashby), although the live response carries `Cache-Control: max-age=60`. Ashby is the richest in structure (`employmentType`, `isRemote`, `workplaceType`, optional compensation).

F6. Greenhouse descriptions are HTML-escaped and need sanitising [HIGH]

In the live response, `content` starts with `<div class="content-intro"…`, i.e. HTML entities. The adapter must unescape and then sanitise before storing the raw description and before extracting plain text for matching.

F7. A source is one company board, so a company list is required [HIGH]

Greenhouse, Lever and Ashby are all addressed per company. Of 18 Greenhouse tokens probed, 14 returned 200 (including `databricks` 885, `stripe` 717, `mongodb` 392 postings) and 4 returned 404 (`cohere`, `perplexityai`, `mistral`, `huggingface`: those companies use another ATS or another token). Tokens must therefore be validated when added.

F8. The feed is relevant to the target profile [MEDIUM]

In the Anthropic board, 55 of 640 titles contained "applied", "solutions" or "forward deployed" (for example "Applied AI Architect"), showing the source can surface AI solutions/integration roles. This is one board and one keyword probe, so it is indicative only.

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CHAPTER 06

Analysis

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Analysis

Greenhouse combines the strongest signals for a first adapter: public and unauthenticated, large coverage, stable identifiers, `updated_at`, ETag support and full content in one call. Its main weakness is the lack of published limits, which is a configuration problem (conservative defaults and backoff), not a blocker. Because all three vendors are queried per company, the real design unit is a *source type + board identifier*; this fits the planned `SourceConfiguration` (URL, rate limit, enabled) and makes the GUI-managed company list a core feature rather than an extra. The 404s show that validation on add is necessary.

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CHAPTER 07

Conclusion

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Conclusion

The first V1 source should be the Greenhouse Job Board API: it works without authentication, returns real data today, and provides the change-detection fields and conditional requests that the collection pipeline needs. Lever and Ashby are confirmed to work and can follow through the same adapter interface.

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CHAPTER 08

Recommendations

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Recommendations

Verified starting watchlist (Greenhouse, HTTP 200 on 2026-10-07): `anthropic`, `databricks`, `scaleai`, `mongodb`, `datadog`, `cloudflare`, `stripe`, `elastic`, `gitlab`, `figma`, `airbnb`, `twilio`, `duolingo`, `samsara`. This list is only a starting point for development and testing; the user's real watchlist is entered in the GUI.

1. To satisfy ODR-004, adopt **Greenhouse** as the first source type, with Lever then Ashby as later adapters, because Greenhouse offers the best change-detection and efficiency features (F2, F3).
2. To stay a polite client, default to **at most one run per board per day**, send `If-None-Match`, enforce timeouts, and back off on 429/5xx, because no limits are published (F4).
3. To keep matching reliable, **unescape then sanitise** descriptions during normalisation, keeping the raw payload in the snapshot (F6).
4. To handle the per-company model, store board tokens as editable configuration managed in the GUI, **validate a token on add** (HTTP 200 and a non-empty `jobs` array), and surface 404 as a clear configuration error in the source status view (F7).
5. To start quickly, seed a small verified watchlist (below), editable by the user.
6. Before any public OSS release, review the vendors' terms formally (ODR-007), since none of the three documents explicit usage terms (F4, F5).

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CHAPTER 09

Limitations

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Limitations

Counts are a snapshot from one day. Only Greenhouse was checked for ETag/304 behaviour. Rate-limit behaviour under load was deliberately not tested, to avoid stressing public services. Vendor terms of service were not reviewed legally.

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CHAPTER 10

Sources

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Sources

#	Title	Credibility	URL
1	Greenhouse Job Board API (official)	High	https://docs.greenhouse.io/job-board.html
2	Lever Postings API (official repository)	High	https://github.com/lever/postings-api
3	Ashby public job posting API (official)	High	https://developers.ashbyhq.com/docs/public-job-posting-api
4	Greenhouse API for many companies (JobsPipe)	Medium (secondary)	https://jobspipe.dev/blog/greenhouse-api-for-many-companies
5	Greenhouse rate limits (apis.io)	Medium (secondary)	https://apis.io/rate-limits/greenhouse/greenhouse-rate-limits/
6	Live API requests, 2026-10-07	High (direct observation)	endpoints listed in F1